Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

UPI fraud is one of the most common cybercrimes today, especially among students and ordinary people. It usually happens when a fraudster tricks someone into sharing sensitive details or approving a fake payment request.

For example, a college student named Riya received a call from a person pretending to be a bank officer. He said her account would be blocked if she didn't "verify" it immediately. He sent her a link and asked her to enter her UPI PIN. In panic, she followed the steps without thinking. Within minutes, money was deducted from her account.

Typically, this fraud happens step-by-step: first, the scammer creates urgency or fear, then gains trust by acting official, and finally tricks the victim into sharing OTP, PIN, or approving a payment request. Students, elderly people, and those unfamiliar with digital systems are easy targets.

The consequences can be serious — financial loss, stress, and loss of trust in online systems.

This situation could have been avoided if Riya stayed calm and followed basic precautions. Banks never ask for PINs or OTPs. She should have verified the call, avoided clicking unknown links, and never shared confidential details. Awareness, patience, and basic digital safety knowledge are the best ways to prevent such frauds.